

HUMAN RESOURCE

written by

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INT. OFFICE - NIGHT

RINGING rattles off glass meeting rooms hued in greens and reds. But no Team Members are at their desks.

Not that they're really *theirs*. Hüm Automations features an open-plan office, with a range of flexible spaces for both Work and Life...

RING

...a snack-stocked kitchen, a sage-scented meditation room, and a black marble coffee bar with a barista named Kevin.

RING

But it's too late for Kevin now. And the kitchen's closed too.

Yet BASS THUMPS the floors. Punctured only by--

RINGING

from behind rows of lush bamboo, where sleek white standing desks are empty. Except, of course:

SHAE'S DESK

with its motivational sticky notes and pinned polaroids of Team Members embracing at corporate retreats...

...and the Cisco 7800 shrieking its industry-leading:

RING--

SHAE (29, accessible in a company fleece) snaps it up.

SHAE
HR, this is--

RAM (PHONE)
Shae.

The voice ripples down her spine.

RAM (PHONE) (CONT'D)
I know what you're doing.

She swirls her chair to scan the office...but it's empty.

As she spins back--

Her laptop SNAPS shut.

RAM, the 40ish Chief Operating Officer, looms over her.

RAM
Time to go.

She opens her mouth to protest.

But he just shakes his head and turns away...

...then bends forward. She exhales.

Then hops on his back for a piggyback ride down the hall.

RAM
Relax. You've practiced enough.
You're gonna crush it tomorrow.

BASS becomes MUSIC as Ram opens the door to a:

PARTY

with a bountiful buffet, a bouncing dance floor, and a gaggle of buzzed TEAMMATES. And on stage:

GUS HÜM (Founder & CEO) pacing in plain black.

GUS
--founded this company with one
simple idea: that our tools will
make us *more human* - not less.

At the buffet, THE PARTNER (60s, cargo shorts) gnashes buffalo wings. Teeth ripping sticky red flesh from the bone.

GUS (CONT'D)
That software can handle the noise,
so people can do the work.
(catching Partner's eye)
And that's only possible with the
continued support of Olympus
Capital. So, thank you.

The Partner returns a saucy smile, hands a clean bone to his hulking CONSULTANT beside him. Licks his fingers.

GUS (CONT'D)
And thank you to everyone here.
Because the real value of this
place isn't products. It's *people*.

The Partner stops licking.

Down the buffet, Shae discreetly wraps shrimp in a napkin.

SHAE'S DESK - MINUTES LATER

Shae pops open her laptop, revealing a PowerPoint deck (ShaeValue.ppt). Slides detailing 8 years of contributions and a convincing case for promotion to Vice President.

She digs into the shrimp. And clicks through the slides.

Each CLICK advancing a slide. Each slide a moment of her evening in an **OPENING SEQUENCE**:

- CLICK. Shae reviews her bio page.
- CLICK. Shae prints 12 copies.
- CLICK. A wheel rotates slowly.
- CLICK. Exercise bike. Going nowhere. Deck propped on bar.
- CLICK. Shae washes her face.
- CLICK. Shae drops her head on a pillow.
- CLICK. Shae turns off the lights.

SEQUENCE ENDS as she straps on her sleep-mask.

Shae turns over. Sinks into the pillow. Drifting off, until--
DING!

Shae sits up, confused. Peels off the sleep-mask.

Carefully tiptoes to door...

...cracks it, and peeks out to the:

MAIN FLOOR

of the OFFICE just as Gus races off the elevator.

He zips by a door marked MEDITATION ROOM but doesn't see:

Shae peering through the crack, from inside.

MEDITATION ROOM

Once he's out of sight, Shae exhales.

Through the door, a sliver of light shines on the front page of her deck, just the middle chunk of her title (Head of Human Resources), illuminating:

HUMAN RESOURCE

Shae closes the door. Room goes dark, leaving the words unreadable. She goes back to sleep.

GUS'S OFFICE - SAME

Gus hurries into his office and finds:

THE PARTNER (O.S.)
Party's over, Gus.

The Partner at his desk, licking an ice cream cone.

THE PARTNER (CONT'D)
It was a cute speech. But you know
the new product is the only reason
Olympus invested in this company.

The hulking CONSULTANT rises from the sofa. Gus trembles.

THE PARTNER (CONT'D)
Everything else is replaceable.
(lick)
Especially you.

GUS
There is no product without me.

THE PARTNER
Not yet.

The Consultant LOCKS the door behind Gus.

BLOOD DRIPS

as rare steak is sliced the next morning.

INT. OFFICE - KITCHEN - DAY

REVEAL steak being sliced in the breakfast taco buffet.

Shae joins two female JAMIES in line.

JAMIE 1	JAMIE 2
Morning Shae Shae!	Morning Shae Shae!

SHAE
Morning, Jamies.

JAMIE 1
Today the day?

Shae shrugs, coy, as they walk the taco line.

JAMIE 2
You hear about Laura?

SHAE

Laura O?

JAMIE 2

No, Laura with the--

Jamie gestures to her face area. *Ohh.*

JAMIE 2

Yeah. BetaWave just made her VP.

SHAE

Good for her. Like, *really* good.
*Especiall*y for her. You know, I
 basically taught her everything.
 And honestly--
 (overstuffing tortilla)
 --she wasn't even that good.

JAMIE 2

Good enough to be a Vice President.

SHAE

Yeah. Pulling 80 hours a week.

JAMIE 1

Looks like she's at the beach.

Jamie whips out a phone to reveal Laura's Instagram post:
 magic hour at the beach - framed by watercolor villas.

SHAE

Is that in Italy? Lucky.

JAMIE 1

You can go to the beach, Shae.

SHAE

Nice try. But people need me.

Jamies' eyes roll as--

DARA (O.S.)

Shae? I need you.

SHAE'S DESK - MINUTES LATER

Shae focuses on her PowerPoint.

Meanwhile, baby associate DARA (23, sleeves over wrists)
 stands at her shoulder, anxious.

Behind them, the WHITE BOARD reads:

Q1: LEAN IN

DARA

--and he was weird about it. Like *I* was being weird. So should I talk to him again? Or is *that* weird?

SHAE

It's only weird if you're weird. And you're not weird, Dara. You're a badass *adult* woman who knows what she's doing.

DARA

Right. And what am I doing?

Dara lifts a thumbnail to her teeth - but Shae pulls it away without even looking.

DARA (CONT'D)

Please just tell me what to do. I don't wanna get yelled at again.

SHAE

(halting, not turning)

Wait. He *yelled* at you?

DARA

I just said that.

SHAE

No. You said he was weird about it.

(typing again with force)

That he made you feel like *you* were being weird. But you never said that he *yelled* at you...Dara...

Shae stabs Ctrl+S and swings to Dara. Gently:

SHAE (CONT'D)

...did he yell at you?

ZEKI (PRE-LAP)

I asked her to do her job.

ZEKI'S DESK - LATER

Shae patiently sits with the impatiently coding ZEKI (30s).

SHAE

Right. But the thing is, that's not *your* job. If you have concerns with an HR associate, you come to me.

ZEKI

I'm not concerned about your mini-me, Shae. I'm concerned about...*me*.

SHAE

Why? Ram said you're irreplaceable.

ZEKI

Everyone is replaceable. You know what we build here.

(beat, turning)

And I can't lose this job.

Shae follows his nervous eyes to a framed photo of his family in Turkey. She overdoes a sympathetic sigh.

SHAE

Listen, I get it--

ZEKI

No. You don't. You work here because you *can*. I work here because I'm *temporarily permitted*. If I don't get another H1-B...

SHAE

Zeki. If the company promised you a Green Card, they'll handle it.

ZEKI

But you basically *are* this company, Shae. Why can't you handle it?

SHAE

Because that's above my head.

She smirks. *For now*. Then struts off. Leaving Zeki confused.

COFFEE BAR - MINUTES LATER

Hunky barista KEVIN preps an iced latte for an incoming Shae.

SHAE

My angel. Can you actually make it hot for me today?

KEVIN

But you're already on fire.

She blushes and pulls out her phone, as he foams her milk.

SHAE

I didn't see you at the party.

KEVIN

Oh I thought that was for like,
actual employees.

SHAE

Kevin. You're part of the family.

Just then, Shae sees a beach pic on her phone. Same beach as Laura's instagram. But it's not Laura. It's a DAD with a teen girl - in a message chain with someone named NINA.

KEVIN

Is that your sister?

SHAE

Only half. But I guess everyone
prefers the new and improved model.
(under breath)
He really can't find another beach?

As she steams, he slides her a STEAMING LATTE under eye-line.

KEVIN

There's taro buns in the kitchen.
If you haven't had your yogurt yet.

SHAE

What would I do without you?

KEVIN

Spend less time in the office?

She SNORTS foam. *Funny*. Then she marches off with a smile...

...leaving Kevin rolling his eyes. He wasn't joking.

SHAE (PRE-LAP)

The true value of a company is its
people. And that's my job--

CONFERENCE ROOM - LATER

Shae recites her spiel as she places printed POWERPOINT DECKS
around a table. Muffins too.

SHAE (CONT'D)

--building a home for human capital
to flourish. And as Vice President--

DOOR OPENS for--

SHAE

Ram?

Ram collapses onto the sofa. Phone falls to the floor.

SHAE

What's going on? This is the most important meeting of my life. Are you seriously hungover right now?

RAM

Shae. It's a bloodbath.

SHAE

Well then stop doing coke with Grady! Just take some advil or something before Gus gets here.

RAM

Gus is never coming back here. As of today, he's *persona non grata*.

SHAE

Is that in Italy?
(under breath)
Is everyone at the beach?

Shae grabs a muffin for a nervous bite--

RAM

No. Shae. I mean: Gus is dead--

--SPRAYS MUFFIN before Ram can finish--

RAM (CONT'D)

--to us. Olympus Capital *terminated* him last night.

SHAE

What. They can't do that.

RAM

They own 100% of our equity now.
They can do whatever they want.

Finally, Shae picks up Ram's phone. NEWS ARTICLE on screen:

BLOODBATH! TECH MARKET MELTS DOWN, FIRMS SCRAMBLE TO SURVIVE

RAM (CONT'D)

And they want to restructure.
As of this morning, the firm's controlling shares have been transferred to some special purpose LLC to oversee the transition.

DING!

SHAE
What. Who's Elsie?

COLD AIR WHOOSHES inside as Ram cracks the door to see:

ELLSIE

gliding off the elevator with icy efficiency. Ageless in a tailored suit, she assesses her new domain. Then enters Gus's office like a parasite infecting its host.

Ram scurries over to meet his new boss...

...leaving Shae alone with her "Shae Value" deck. Fuck.

MEDITATION ROOM

Shae rushes in. Stashes her personal items (clothes, sheets, toiletries) in the closet. Then finds her Shae Value deck. She RIPS it in half. Then again. Again. Again.

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - LATER

Shae pretends to work. But watches Ellsie - in her new office - issue Ram instructions while purging Gus's personal items.

DARA (O.S.)
Shae. Something's wrong.

Dara rolls her chair up. Eyes wide with panic.

SHAE
What? Nothing's wrong.

DARA
But Grady says we're getting gutted.

SHAE
Dara, please. Grady's a clinical moron. We only hired him because of his dad's hedge fund.

Sales guy GRADY (fleece vest, beautiful hair) leans over.

GRADY
And who do you think told me, Shae?
(reading text on phone)
He said we're "fat on the belly and the butcher's on the way".

Shae turns to him with sympathy: *he texted you that?*

Dara's eyes well up. Shae wraps her up like a camp counselor.

SHAE

Relax. Ram can handle this.

Ram emerges. Followed by his handler, Ellsie.

RAM

Morning everyone. Um. I know things seem...*frantic* recently. But we have some exciting updates for you about the future of this company--

ELLSIE

This company is insolvent.

(beat)

I will be salvaging any valuable assets prior to liquidation. Carry on your assigned tasks as normal.

Everyone looks at Shae. Dara pulls at her sweater like a kid in the supermarket: *say something!*

SHAE

But I thought we were doing well.

ELLSIE

At what?

(off Shae's glitch)

What do you do?

SHAE

Oh. We're a global provider of--

ELLSIE

No. What does this company do?

Shae stammers. Ellsie scans the crowd for another answer...

ZEKI

We build and sell automated B2C engagement software. Like chatbots. Customer service phone trees.

Ellsie assesses him. Then points to Gus's old office. Zeki quickly complies. Ellsie turns to follow him, but--

SHAE

But we're more than that. We have a really special culture here.

ELLSIE

Your culture is a luxury. And a relic of low interest rates.

SHAE
Well I'm sorry but--

ELLSIE
Why? Did you do something wrong?

SHAE
No, it's just - if you destroy the culture, all the best people will leave. It'll be a bloodbath.

ELLSIE
(processing, then)
Okay. I appreciate the insight.

Ellsie proceeds to her new office to meet Zeki.

Shae circles around to see: everyone smiling. It's a win!

A WEEK LATER

Shae circles around to see: an emptying office. It's a--

RAM (O.S.)
--bloodbath.

Ram slumps in a chair. Grady and the Jamies at nearby desks.

SHAE
Relax. She hasn't fired anyone yet.

JAMIE 1
She's smoking us out. Everyone who can get another job is leaving.

SHAE
(noticing Dara listening)
Great. So she needs us.

JAMIE 2
She's here to gut us. We need her.

GRADY
I don't need her.

SHAE
Grady. You have a DUI.

GRADY
CUI. And Jamie's thing is worse!

JAMIE 1
You told him?

JAMIE 2
You told him?

SHAE
Jamies, please! What can we do?

JAMIE 1
Quit before it's too late?

JAMIE 2
No. If we get fired, we can get
severance *and* unemployment.

Dara chomps her nail and runs off. Shae chases after.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - CONTINUOUS

Shae finds Dara stepping up on a MAINTENANCE LADDER.

SHAE
Where do you think you're going?

Dara looks up - from the first floor, the ladder goes up forever...but not back down to ground level. She exhales and sinks down, against the ladder. Shae wraps her shivering body in a cardigan. Sits.

DARA
What am I gonna tell my family?

SHAE
They'll understand. It's not like
they replaced you with another
daughter or anything.

DARA
Shae. This isn't about you.

SHAE
Sorry, I mean: you have value.
Someone will see that.

DARA
That's easy for you to say. You're
already...*there*. And I'm what?
Going back to Michigan to be
another New York burnout?

Dara tries to bite a pinky - but Shae gently takes her hand.

SHAE
Dara. I will die before I let you
go back to Michigan.

DARA
Shae. *This isn't about you.*

INT. OFFICE - LATER

Shae marches to Gus's old office. Ram scrambling behind her.

RAM
--please don't. She's only keeping
me to keep things calm. And I can't
get fired. I have nowhere to go!

SHAE
I'm not scared of her.

RAM
Well maybe you should be.

~~GUS'S OFFICE~~ ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Shae surprises Ellsie at her desk. Ram at Shae's heels.

RAM
I told her not to--

ELLSIE
Leave.

Shae gulps and follows Ram out--

ELLSIE
Not you.

Both turn back. Ellsie nods to Ram, who gets it. Leaves.

SHAE
It's Elsie, right?

ELLSIE
There are two L's.

Ellsie sits at her computer. Shae notices a trashbag with Gus's stuff. And a POTTED PLANT with brown, crispy leaves.

SHAE
Sure. Anyway. I uh, wanted to see
if you wanted to get some coffee?
Kevin is...*amazing*.

ELLSIE
A Keurig can do his job.

SHAE
Right. Okay. Well, this is actually
what I wanted to talk about. You
have such a clear communication--

ELLSIE
This a problem?

SHAE
No, no. That's actually the good
part. And not really the point--

ELLSIE
Then why did you say it?

SHAE
To cushion the critical feedback.
(miming a sandwich)
It's uh, it's a compliment sandwich.

ELLSIE
It's a condescending waste of time.

SHAE
It's our culture. And I told you if
you destroy it, people will leave.

ELLSIE
And I told you I appreciated the
insight. Those voluntary departures
lowered our severance liabilities.

GASP. She is here to gut them. But it gets worse.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Yet liabilities remain.

Ellsie finally turns her full attention to Shae. Uh oh.

ELLSIE
Shae. What do you do?
(anticipating)
Not your title. When you are at
your desk, what do you actually do?

SHAE
Sorry, I--

ELLSIE
Stop apologizing and answer me.

SHAE
I do people stuff! Okay? I get them
to show up. I get them to *care*. And
that's irreplaceable. And it's why,
before you got here, they were gonna
promote me to Vice President!

Ellsie looks her up and down with utter pity.

ELLSIE

Shae. They were never going to make you a Vice President.

SHAE

What. I've given my life--

ELLSIE

Exactly. Why would they pay extra?

SHAE

You don't understand. I basically, like, *am* this company.

ELLSIE

No. You don't understand.

Ellsie backs the terrified Shae to the door...

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

You are rented labor trained to accept validation, frivolity, and a false sense of security in lieu of material compensation.

...until Shae is in the hall.

ELLSIE

I am the company now.

Ellsie SLAMS the door on her face. Then hears a SQUEAK.

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - NIGHT

SQUEAKING of Shae's mouse as she furiously pages through apartment listings. She changes the price filter. NO RESULTS.

The floor is silent. It's late. But Ellsie's still in her office, so Shae can't "go home" yet.

THUMP. Shae hears the sound coming from Ellsie's office.

THUMP. Shae approaches carefully. The blinds are drawn, but light bleeds through a crack. And now she hears:

THUMP. HISS. THUMP. HISS. THUMP. HISS.

Shae leans in. Through the gap:

A SHADOW moving in rhythm. A BARE FOOT stomping on the ground repeatedly. It's fucking weird. THUMP. HISS. THUMP. HISS.

As Shae leans closer, the sounds halt and--

ELLSIE'S EYE fills the crack.

Shae JOLTS back. Spins around and races toward:

RAM'S OFFICE

and bolts inside. Closes the door. Catches her breath.

RAM (O.S.)
Are you okay?

Shae JUMPS. She didn't realize Ram was there.

SHAE
Yeah. She's just...doing something
in there.

She turns and sees Ram lying on the sofa. Looking pathetic.

SHAE
Are you okay?

RAM
Gus won't return my calls. Do you
think he hates me for staying?

SHAE
(sitting, sympathetic)
*Hate you? He's just in Bali or
whatever. But you know he loves
you. I mean, Ram, he made you COO.*

RAM
Please. You know I only got the job
because Doug got caught on that
website, and I...I had just *been*
here forever. I never knew what I
was doing. I'm an imposter.
(jumping her protest)
It's okay. That's my thing. I'm
good at being seen as good. But
that only works in a bull market.
And now, well...the bear is here.

SHAE
Don't call her that. That's sexist.

RAM
The bear market, Shae. No one's
buying my act in a downturn. But
you, you can still get out of here.

Shae shakes her head, on the verge of tears.

RAM

You have to. At least interview--

SHAE

I did! I applied to 17 companies. I emailed every HR person I know. 4 ignored me. 13 bounced back.

RAM

Because you had the wrong emails?

SHAE

Because they got fired, Ram! No one wants them. No one wants *me*. I thought this was all I knew how to do. But apparently I'm not even good at it. Just good at *seeming good*--
(hearing it now)
Oh my god. Ram. I'm the imposter.

Ram waves his hands: no!

SHAE

Seriously think about it. We played one drunk game of laser tag like six years ago. Then things went well and you gave me all this credit because you *liked* me. Then once you became my mentor or whatever, you *had* to pretend I was good. Because if I wasn't, what would it say about you?

RAM

Jesus, Shae. That's sick.

SHAE

It's true! And now I'm locked in. I gave my whole life to advance here. And all the sudden, here is over and I can never get *there*?

Ram looks around. Where?

MEDITATION ROOM - MINUTES LATER

Shae dribbles in. Head down like charlie brown. Kills the lights. Flops onto the made-up sofa.

In the darkness, she whimpers into the pillow.

ELLSIE (O.S.)

So. This really is your home.

LIGHTS ON. Ellsie sits calmly in the corner.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

I've never seen someone actually
bring their *whole self* to work.

SHAE

It's temporary. The market is just
crazy. And my roommate moved out--
(off Ellsie's blank stare)
And technically there's no rule
against it. And I like it here. I
have everything I need. For free.

ELLSIE

Nothing is free.

SHAE

Sure. I guess like, *metaphorically*.

ELLSIE

I don't use metaphors on company
time. Food, facilities, freezing
your eggs. The perks are here to
keep you here. And here you are.

SHAE

And? Why are you here?

ELLSIE

My job is to invest in distressed
assets, strip their liabilities,
and maximize their value.

Shae deflates onto a yoga ball, which deflates.

SHAE

I get it. I'm the liability.

ELLSIE

No, Shae. You're just distressed.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE - MINUTES LATER

In pajamas, Shae watches Ellsie use gardening scissors to
SNIP dead leaves off the plant. She kept it. Nice.

ELLSIE

Gus was a fine engineer, but he
failed to deliver the product he
promised. Instead wasting resources
on diversions like...email chains.
Birthday cake. Meetings.

SHAE

We're having brainstorming sessions
on how to trim back on those.

ELLSIE

We have to trim *everything* if this
firm is going to survive, Shae.

SNIP. Ellsie looks up at an ORG CHART on the wall. A massive
web of faces, names, and titles. SNIP.

ELLSIE

It will be a difficult transition.
That's why I'm retaining Ram as
Interim CEO. But I still need an
additional resource to help
acclimate the headcount to our new
economic reality. Someone with a
bit of...*human touch*.

Shae quietly GASPS. But doesn't respond. Ellsie sits.

ELLSIE

Shae. I'm expressing a need for
your services. This is the part
when you tell me what you want.

SHAE

Well maybe I can review the details
first and then we can circle back?

ELLSIE

There is no circle. Just a line
from your supply to my demand.
So, show me the line.

SHAE

Vice President.

Ellsie's surprised at the quick response. But squints. *Why?*

SHAE

Because that's how I get there.

Ellsie looks around. *Where?*

SHAE

There. Where I've made it. Where I
have security. Where I can just...*go*
to the beach without worrying about
falling behind, or being replaced.

ELLSIE

Employees can always be replaced.

SHAE
Aren't you an Olympus employee?

ELLSIE
The Partners at Olympus are both my
shareholders and clients. But I
remain an independent entity. As I
told you before:
(beat)
I am the company.

Oh. Shae realizes that was never a metaphor.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
I know it pains everyone to admit,
but Mitt Romney was right.

Ellsie leans in, practically purring.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
About corporations being people.
(savoring the concept)
We're all just *independent agents*
transacting value.
(eyes flashing)
And Shae, I see your value.

GASP. It's everything Shae's ever wanted to hear.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
In fact, I'd like to discuss an
investment opportunity.

SHAE
An investment in what?

ELLSIE
You.

Ellsie slides over an EQUITY AGREEMENT. Shae blinks.

ELLSIE
My Analyst can help with the details.

Ellsie rises and opens a closet door.

CLOSET - MOMENTS LATER

Shae sits with a red-eyed, neck-tatted ANALYST (late 20s),
churning out spreadsheets. Monitors flashing manically.

SHAE
Is this a bad time?

ANALYST

Market's in a death spiral. Firms
are being stripped for parts.

(smile)

No better time for private equity.

He shakes a container with a MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

ANALYST

Meal replacement? Their Russian
portfolio company makes it.

SHAE

I'm okay. Is that like Soylent?

ANALYST

Not according to the FDA.

He scoops GREEN POWDER into water. Stirs. Sips.

ANALYST

So. She's gonna invest in you.

SHAE

Maybe. Unless it's a bad idea?

ANALYST

It's a great idea. As long as you
know what you're doing.

SHAE

Totally. And what am I doing?

ANALYST

Selling shares in yourself. So you
get cash now. And she gets a stake
in your future value. You
understand how equity works?

SHAE

That's like stock, right?

He nods.

SHAE

Then no.

ANALYST

Okay. Let's start with the basics.

He jumps to his feet.

ANALYST (CONT'D)

Finance...is like time travel.

He waits for this to land. It doesn't.

ANALYST (CONT'D)

Think about your student loans. You borrow money from the future to pay for school in the present. But you have to pay it back no matter what. So the lender doesn't care about you beyond your ability to pay.

SHAE

They're not *invested* in me.

ANALYST

Bingo. But with equity, you don't pay anything back. Your shares rise in value as you rise in value. So development and growth are in your investor's best interest. Got it?

SHAE

For sure. 100%. It's just that, it doesn't really make any sense.

ANALYST

That's the beauty of finance, Shae. It doesn't need to make *sense*.
(eyes twinkling)
It just needs to make *money*. And you just need to create value.

SHAE

Don't I have value...*inside me*?

ANALYST

I guess. But she doesn't care what you are. What matters is what you do. Exploit underutilized resources. And find any way possible to grow assets or cut liabilities. It's a simple formula.

He scribbles on a pad: EQUITY = ASSETS - LIABILITIES.

ANALYST (CONT'D)

That's your valuation. Benchmarked against expectation of course.

SHAE

But how does she set expectations? We can't see the future.

ANALYST

But we *can* simulate it in a model.

SHAE
In our minds?

ANALYST
In Excel.

He pops open some spreadsheets. She's overwhelmed.
He shakes the container of GREEN POWDER. It helps!

CUT TO:

30-50 MINUTES LATER

Shae's bopping around on her toes. Really getting it now.

SHAE
Finance is like time travel!

Analyst pumps his fist. Yeah!

SHAE
It doesn't need to make sense.

Analyst gives PRAYER HANDS and BOWS – preach!

SHAE (CONT'D)
I can calculate my present value by
estimating my assets, liabilities,
and future growth expectations!

Shae takes a big gulp of green drink.

ANALYST
So. Shae. How much are you worth?

He pulls up a spreadsheet: SHAE-VALUE.xlsx.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - NEXT MORNING

The SHAE-VALUE excel sheet on her monitor.

Shae's alone. Clearly up all night. Green still on her lips.

She peeks at an old copy of her printed SHAE-VALUE deck.
Compared to the new excel sheet, it looks so quaint.

She tosses it in the trash.

Then turns to her WHITE BOARD. Replaces Q1: LEAN IN with-

Q2: LEAN OPERATIONS

The marker SQUEAKS.

INT. OFFICE - BIKE ROOM - MORNING

SQUEAKING on the SPINNING WHEEL of the EXERCISE BIKE.

Shae's pumping away in a room full of bikes. But she's alone, sipping green drink. Spinning the wheel faster with a HISS--

PRE-LAP: HISS. THUMP. HISS. THUMP--

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

THUMP as Ellsie pivots, planting her bare foot.

HISS as she exhales and STRIKES with her opposite fist. She's doing some kickboxing-style routine. It's rhythmic. And disciplined. And weird.

THUMP. HISS. THUMP. HISS--

SERVER ROOM

HISS of servers in long rows...leading to a desk in front of a WALL OF MONITORS...

...where Zeki codes. Locked in. Beside him, a container of green powder with the MOUSE DOCTOR logo. Fingers TAP faster.

COFFEE BAR - LATER THAT MORNING

Kevin TAPS an espresso handle, knocking out old grounds. Then grinds fresh beans for:

Shae, on her phone. LinkedIn. Checking her new title: VP of People Operations. Clicks SHARE, but with who? Opens messages with DAD. But it's just pics of fuckin' Nina. And months of "coming home anytime soon?" and "sorry - crazy busy at work".

Kevin slides a latte under her eyeline. In foam: an S.

She smirks. Turns to Ellsie's office. Light's on. Hm.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE - CONTINUOUS

Shae finds Ellsie SNIPPING dead leaves from Gus's plant. It's still brown, but coming back to life. Nice!

SHAE
I didn't realize you were here.

ELLSIE
I was just checking on Francis.

SHAE
Francis, nice. So is he like your--

ELLSIE
I need cuts to recurring expenses.

SHAE
Expenses. Sure. For example...

ELLSIE
For example: *lunch*.

SHAE
That...might be tricky for morale.

ELLSIE
Morale is not my concern.

SHAE
But it's mine. And data clearly
show correlation with performance.
Plus, it costs us nothing to be
attentive to the emotional context.

Ellsie reviews her. Shae's finally speaking her language.

ELLSIE
Fine. Attend to it.
(as Shae takes the win)
But there will be no lunch.

GRADY (PRE-LAP)
So we just *pay* for it ourselves?

KITCHEN - LUNCHTIME

Dara, Grady, and the Jamies unpack salads. Shae scoops green powder into her Nalgene.

SHAE
We were always paying, Grady. The
lunch money came out of the
employee discretionary budget.
Money that *could've* gone to you.

JAMIE 1
Where's it going now?

SHAE

The balance sheet. To pay for us.

DARA

That doesn't make any sense.

SHAE

If it's saving our jobs, does it really need to make sense?

JAMIE 1

Yes.

JAMIE 2

Yes.

Dara's still worried.

SHAE

What are you worried about?

Dara shrugs. Lifts a fingernail to her teeth--

But Shae gently pulls her hand away gently.

SHAE

Then stop worrying. I can protect us. Everything's going to be fine.

SCREAMING from the hallway.

HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS

Shae finds Ram running after something, pointing.

RAM

A mouse ran over my foot! There!

They see the mouse scurry through a vent into the:

SERVER ROOM

where Shae and Ram race inside. Look around for the mouse.

BUZZ! It's on the floor. Electrocuted by some homemade techno mouse trap. It's horrifying.

ZEKI (O.S.)

Shae? What are you doing?

Zeki looks over from his desk. She looks at the dead mouse.

SHAE

What are you doing?

ZEKI

Oh. They love the heat in here. And the old traps suck. I made these from laptop batteries.

(proud, then turning back)

But why am I explaining myself?
I don't answer to either of you.

RAM

You don't?

SHAE

Listen, I know you're still upset about the Green Card thing--

RAM

You promised him a Green Card?

ZEKI

This isn't about you, Shae. You just *really* can't be here. Really.

Why? Then Shae notices: Ram staring at a monitor. It's...

Gus. He's been on video conference this whole time.

RAM (CONT'D)

Gus? What the hell are you doing here? I thought you were in Bali.

ZEKI

He *is* in Bali. And the audio isn't working right now. I'm just pulling some of his old code.

SHAE

So he's what, working remotely?

ZEKI

It's just for the new product.

RAM

What new product?

SHAE

What new product?

ELLSIE (O.S.)

The product is in stealth mode.

Ellsie appears behind them. AH!

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

Intellectual property is at high risk with such a...fluid personnel situation in the office.

RAM
But I'm supposed to be the CEO.

ELLSIE
Interim CEO. Do you know what *interim* means, Ramesh? It means: *for now*. And for now, you have one function: *simulating continuity*. Shae will ensure you do this and nothing else.

RAM
So she's, what, my boss?

SHAE
Of course not.

ELLSIE
Yes.

Shae slowly turns to a stunned Ram with a grin.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
Shae. With me.

HALLWAY - MOMENTS LATER

Shae wheezes as she catches up to Ellsie.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Leave Zeki alone. And keep everyone out of that server room. What is the status of recurring expenses?

SHAE
Um, lunch is done. And I canceled the cleaning contracts. I figured we can tidy up after ourselves.

Ellsie stops at a bathroom. Turns. Stares. It's weird.

SHAE
What's...happening right now?

ELLSIE
I'm pleased. And acknowledging you, as I've seen you do with others.

SHAE
But you're not smiling.

Ellsie nods. Shae notices a workout bag in Ellsie's hands.

SHAE
Oh do you work out in here?

ELLSIE
Don't worry about my personal time.
Focus on your circle of competency.

SHAE
...managing resources for humans?

ELLSIE
The humans are the resources. And
there are too many. Deal with them.

She opens the bathroom door. Shae exhales. *This is the job.*

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Starting with Dara.

The door closes on Shae's face.

PRE-LAP: CRYING

INT. OFFICE - MAIN FLOOR - LATER

Dara's CRYING echoes across the main floor. Grady exchanges a look with the Jamies. *What's going on?*

MEETING ROOM - MINUTES AFTER THAT

Dara snuffles. Shae's lap is covered in tissues.

DARA
But you said everything is fine. I
mean, she's giving you a bonus.

SHAE
It's not a bonus. It's equity.
She's investing in my future value.

DARA
But what about *our* value?

Shae thinks. Then sees Team Members watching from outside.

Their distressed faces.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. OFFICE - CONFERENCE ROOM - NEXT DAY

Those same distressed faces. On a printed slide deck. Titled:

HUMAN CAPITAL: INVESTING IN PEOPLE

ELLSIE (O.S.)
But I don't want them.

Ellsie looks across at Shae and the Analyst. They've been up all night. Red eyes. Green lips.

SHAE
No one does. That's the point.
They're distressed assets. And you--

ELLSIE
I know what I do, Shae.

SHAE
Then it would be irresponsible not to at least review the opportunity.

ANALYST
She's right. The market's bottoming out. You'd be buying at the bottom. Check the ROI figures on page 4.

Ellsie reluctantly flips to real data. Hm. Peeks at Analyst.

ELLSIE
You taught her this?

SHAE
You did. I listen to everything you say. And it's led me to this. To *them*. They're worth more to us than anyone else, because we know how to get the most out of them. We know the value *inside them*.

Ellsie's eyes flicker. Shae betrays a tiny smirk.

ELLSIE
Olympus wants this office vacated by Q4.

SHAE
Then we'll get a new office.

But Ellsie closes the deck. Shae sinks.

ELLSIE
We don't need one.

Ellsie picks up the phone.

RAM (PRE-LAP)
Remote Only?

RAM'S OFFICE - LATER

Shae stands as she briefs Ram on the sofa.

SHAE

This is how we can all stay.

RAM

But we're *not* staying. Was this Gus's idea?

SHAE

No...but he was a factor--

(off his scoff)

I mean he's already proven a remote model can work. Now Zeki can scale that across the rest of the team.

RAM

Olympus will never approve this.

ELLSIE (PRE-LAP)

Olympus is enthused.

In the window, he sees the Partner emerging from Ellsie's office. Followed by his hulking Consultant.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE - MINUTES LATER

Shae joins Ellsie in her office.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

They've agreed to lend us their Consultant to assist with the transitions. Still, this will be demanding on you. Mentally as well as physically. Do you have a regular training regimen?

Shae blinks. Then notices Ellsie's workout bag.

SHAE

Oh my god. Are you about to ask me to work out with you?

ELLSIE

I have a fiduciary obligation to care about your physical wellbeing.

SHAE

That's the nicest thing anyone's ever said to me.

YOGA ROOM - THAT NIGHT

Ellsie reviews Shae's gym shorts and company T-shirt.

ELLSIE
This is too flabby.

SHAE
That's why I'm here.

ELLSIE
I mean the excess material leaves
you exposed. Try to strike me.

Ellsie waves her on. Shae winds up and PUNCHES--

Ellsie DUCKS left, THUMPS her foot behind Shae, yanks her shirt then throws her. Shae SMACKS her elbow on the way down. Eyes fill with tears.

ELLSIE
Stop crying.

SHAE
But it hurts.

ELLSIE
Feeling is a message. You can
ignore it. Like email.

Shae stumbles to her feet.

ELLSIE
Now, focus on your timing.

Ellsie waves her to attack. Shae charges at Ellsie--

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Capture momentum.

Ellsie sidesteps with a THUMP.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
And impact with leverage.

Ellsie exhales HISS as she POPS Shae behind the knee, who buckles to the ground. Shae sucks down the tears, and rises off the floor on her own. LFG.

TRAINING MONTAGE - NEXT FEW WEEKS

Ellsie trains Shae in the yoga room, the Analyst trains her in his closet, and Shae signs up assets to the portfolio.

THUMP/HISS keeps rhythm as we cycle around the office:

- SHAE uncaps a green marker. Reviews faces on the ORG CHART.
- ZEKI sips green drink, codes with Gus (on his monitor).
- SHAE pitches the team, deck in hand: INVESTING IN YOU.
- THE JAMIES, GRADY, and others sign their contracts.
- WEBCAM LIGHTS turn GREEN on laptops around the office.
- FACES APPEAR from those webcams on Zeki's WALL OF MONITORS.
- RAM checks his texts to GUS - all green, unread. His contract on his desk, still unsigned.
- ORG CHART has faces circled in green. Except Ram. And Dara.

MATCH CUT TO:

DARA'S DESK (WEEKS LATER)

Shae watches happily as Dara signs her contract.

DARA
Is that everyone?

Shae takes a breath.

RAM'S OFFICE - A LITTLE LATER

Ram watches skeptically as Shae heads to the coffee bar.

COFFEE BAR - MOMENTS LATER

Kevin hands Shae a mug of boiling tea.

KEVIN
Just be careful, that's--

Absentminded, she takes a HUGE GULP of the boiling tea.

KEVIN (CONT'D)
--scalding hot. Are you okay?

Shae's staring at Ram's office, where he's hiding inside. Her cheeks are flat. Eyes bright, greenish.

SHAE
Me? I'm not the one being a baby.

KEVIN

He's just scared. Going remote is kind of a big deal for some people.

She realizes how careless she's being. *Oh, Kevin.*

SHAE

You have nothing to worry about. She promised to keep you until Q4.

KEVIN

It's fine. It's just a job.

SHAE

But what will I do without you?

KEVIN

Spend less time in the office.

She chuckles. But he's dead serious.

SHAE

Sorry. I thought that was a joke.

KEVIN

Why would I joke about that?

SHAE

Because we're friends. I mean, you know what time I eat my yogurt.

KEVIN

Shae. That's the job.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE - A LITTLE LATER

Shae marches in, surprising Ellsie.

SHAE

We can get a Keurig.

Shae marches off. Ellsie turns to the coffee bar.

COFFEE BAR - THAT NIGHT

Ellsie approaches Kevin as he cleans up.

KEVIN

Shae already fired me.

ELLSIE

That is good to hear.

Ellsie blinks.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
But you are still contracted for
another hour.

KEVIN
Just tell me what you want.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
You observe behavior, when you
service the salaried staff. I want
your honest assessment of Shae.

KEVIN
Honestly?

SHAE

listens from around the corner, leaks out a little smile...

KEVIN (O.S.)(CONT'D)
She's unlike anyone I've ever met.
Just completely...delusional.

...which falls right to the floor.

COFFEE BAR

Ellsie notices Shae spying. But Shae quickly vanishes.

KEVIN (CONT'D)
I mean, she basically lives here.
And I think she thinks that's a
good thing? It's kind of pathetic.
(off her blank stare)
But I guess she's good with people.
And she'll do anything for
validation. If that's helpful.

Ellsie nods: *it is*. Kevin's not sure if this is over. After a
bit, he points to the espresso machine.

KEVIN
If you're selling this, can I have
the backup espresso beans in the
freezer? They don't work for drip.

ELLSIE
(processing, then)
Wash the dishes. Pack the machine.
And then you may have your beans.

BASEMENT - AN HOUR LATER

DING! Kevin steps off the elevator and heads for the back exit. But first, he stops at the:

FREEZER

COLD HITS. It's dark. He can't find the light.

PHONE FLASHLIGHT ON. Sweeps the shelves until he finds--

ESPRESSO BEANS. He reaches for the bag but KNOCKS it over.

BEANS SPRAY all over the floor. He crouches to clean up.
CREAK. He looks up at the doorway and sees:

ELLSIE!

THE DOOR CLOSES.

Kevin runs toward the door. Wait!

Grabs the handle. But it's locked. He BANGS!

BASEMENT HALLWAY

BANG BANG BANG from inside the freezer fades as...Ellsie calmly walks back to the elevator.

BANGING becomes DRIBBLING (PRE-LAP)--

INT. OFFICE - COFFEE BAR - NEXT DAY

Shae finds a KEURIG dribbling coffee into a mug for Ellsie.

SHAE

I see Kevin's been optimized for
his core competencies.

ELLSIE

That's a very amusing joke. I'll
reflect on it in my personal time.

DING!

They turn to the elevator, where the Consultant starts pushing out a massive crate on a dolly. Ellsie looks at him, points down. He nods. Pulls the dolly back into the elevator.

SHAE

What's in the box?

ELLSIE
Specialized equipment to help us
assess and process any unseen
liabilities in our new assets.

SHAE
You mean like their health?

PRE-LAP: DING!

BASEMENT - SAME

The Consultant pushes the massive crate off the elevator,
down the hall, toward a WHITE ROOM.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
Their physical wellbeing is our
business now, Shae. But let the
Consultant handle all of that. You
have enough to manage.

BACK TO COFFEE BAR

Ellsie turns provocatively (for her) to Shae.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
For example: your living situation.

SHAE
Right. I get it. If we're going to
be working from home, I should
probably, you know, *get a home*.

ELLSIE
You already have one.

SHAE
Is that a metaphor?

ELLSIE
Call it a bonus.

Ellsie sets down housekeys on the bar.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
The building is in our portfolio.

RAM'S OFFICE - SAME

Ram watches Shae smile at Ellsie. When Ellsie walks off, Shae
turns to Ram. Eye contact. Her smile disappears.

DING-A-LING-A-LING

Ram finds his RINGING laptop. Opens it, revealing:

GUS on video call. Tan. Shell necklace. Tropical background.

RAM

Gus? I've been calling you.

GUS (REMOTE)

Sorry, man. The service here sucks.
And I've been so busy with work.

RAM

Busy sending us home. I heard this
was your idea.

GUS (REMOTE)

Nothing is my idea anymore, Ram.
I'm not in charge. They are. And
they never planned to keep any of
us. You should be happy.

SERVER ROOM - SAME

On the monitor, Zeki watches Gus's video chat with Ram. After a minute, Ram signs his contract.

Ellsie, behind Zeki, dials a number. Walks out.

Zeki scoops some green powder from the MOUSE DOCTOR container into his water. Then leans forward to get back into his code.

PRE-LAP: SQUEAKING

WHITE ROOM - SAME

The Consultant unpacks the crate. It's a machine the size and shape of a tanning bed. On the side: the MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

INT. SHAE'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

DING! ELEVATOR OPENS into Shae's new place. Dara, Grady, and the Jamies step toward the floor-to-ceiling windows.

GRADY

Whoah. This is it?

SHAE

This is it.

Dara slumps onto an unpacked BOX. The place is unfurnished.

DARA

I can't believe this is really it.
I don't want to be apart.

SHAE

Hey. We'll still be together every day. Just remotely. Come on, we're supposed to be celebrating.

GRADY

We're supposed to be getting drunk.

PRE-LAP: POP

A LITTLE LATER

Grady's pouring prosecco in plastic cups. Meanwhile, Shae finds Dara lingering by the window.

SHAE

I haven't told anyone yet. But we're gonna have a party on our last day before Q4. I'm thinking we can do like, a *luau*.

DARA

(smiling, then)

You're not inviting those Olympus guys right?

SHAE

Dara. They're our investors. What are you so worried about?

Dara shrugs and brings her fingers to her teeth--

SHAE

Then stop worrying.

Shae SLAPS Dara's hand away.

PRE-LAP: DING!

LATER

The elevator arrives. Shae hugs everyone as they get on.

DOORS CLOSE on their faces. Shae exhales. Alone for the first time all night. She drifts to the window. The city below.

In the GLASS: her reflection. Behind her, the lingering shapes of Dara, the Jamies, Grady. Laughing.

She smiles at them. The reflection settles. Just her now. Alone in the frame. She smiles wider. She has everything.

BUZZ. She finds her phone. A text from Nina. Uch.

She tosses it. Looks around. Remembers she has no bed.

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. OFFICE - THAT NIGHT

Shae returns to the office. It's empty. Except a light on in:

RAM'S OFFICE

where Shae finds Ram laying on his sofa.

SHAE
You're still here?

RAM
For now. Soon I'll just be another face on a screen.

SHAE
This attitude is bad for morale.

RAM
And you used to be better at this.

SHAE (CONT'D)
Listen. I know you're mad at me--

RAM
This isn't about you, Shae--

SHAE
Well I know Gus is acting weird--

RAM
It's not about Gus either.

SHAE
Then what is it about?

RAM
Us. It's about us. We're being torn apart. And you don't even care. You're becoming...like her.

SHAE

Is that supposed to be a bad thing?

RAM

Shae. She's basically a robot.

SHAE

That's sexist. If a man acted like that, you'd think he was some devoted genius or something.

RAM

I mean it. She has no feelings. Or any life outside this office.

SHAE

That's not true. She actually has a boyfriend. Named Francis. It's you who doesn't have a life.

RAM

I know. And I don't want you to make the same mistakes as me. Don't have nowhere else to go.

SHAE

I just got a new apartment.

RAM

Grady said you didn't even unpack. I know you're still sleeping here.

Shae's jaw locks into place. *Still?* He knew?

RAM (CONT'D)

I'm not judging you. I'm just worried, if she finds out--

And then he sees it in her eyes. Ellsie knows. A quiet beat.

SHAE

She trusts me, Ram. She saw my value when no one else did.

RAM

I get it. And I'm so sor--

SHAE

Stop. Don't do that. I know how hard you fought for my promotion.

(beat)

Right?

RAM

Shae. I'm so sorry--

SHAE

Stop apologizing and tell me the tr--

RAM

The truth is I'm sorry. I wanted you to have it. *Obviously*. But things were crazy. And you, you were our rock. I knew you'd stay. And I guess...we didn't have to. But now, as your friend--

SHAE

We're not friends, Ram. You were my boss. And now I'm yours. And from here, I can see you were right the whole time. You are an imposter. And you're transitioning tonight.

RAM

But you said I had until Q4--

SHAE

It sends a stronger message to the team to start with the CEO. Go see the Consultant before he leaves.

RAM

No. Please. Something's wrong--

SHAE

He just needs to do a quick scan--

RAM

--with *her*. She scares me.

SHAE

(rising for door)

You're just threatened by a woman who doesn't buy your bullshit.

RAM

I'm not threatened by you.

SHAE

Well maybe you should be.

MAIN FLOOR

Shae SLAMS the door behind her. Then marches off, past the:

SERVER ROOM

where Zeki's passed out at his desk. Green on lips. Beside him, the MOUSE DOCTOR container RATTLES...

PRE-LAP: DING!

INT. SHAE'S APARTMENT - A LITTLE LATER

Shae strolls back in. Covered in boxes. Checks a text from NINA: *"Hey. My mom asked if ur coming home for dads bday?"*.

She dismisses it. Thinks. Then opens again, responds: *"Hey. Have a huge work thing and I'm moving into my new place. But tell him I'll try to call."* Thinks. Adds *"XOXO"*.

Then grabs a boxcutter. Starts unpacking her new life.

INT. OFFICE - BASEMENT HALLWAY - SAME

DING! Ram steps off the elevator and sees the Consultant waiting outside the white room.

CHEERY MUSIC playing inside.

INTERCUT:**- SHAE'S APARTMENT**

CHEERY MUSIC echoes off empty walls from Shae's phone.

She slices boxes with the boxcutter.

MUSIC STOPS. Phone's dead. As she hunts for a charger, she KNOCKS the boxcutter to the floor with a CLACK.

- SERVER ROOM

CLACK goes the container as it FALLS OVER onto Zeki's desk.

A MOUSE scurries out...covered in green powder...

...right past Zeki's pale, sleeping face. He doesn't wake up.

- WHITE ROOM

Ram follows the Consultant into the cheery music. Sees the MACHINE. Like a tanning bed.

The Consultant opens it. Gestures for Ram to get inside.

Ram turns to the door, but the Consultant snaps it shut.

PRE-LAP: BUZZING

- SERVER ROOM

BUZZING finally wakes Zeki.

He drops to his knees, follows a trail of green powder...to an electric mouse trap...

...and a MOUSE being electrocuted. Licking green powder off itself. Undisturbed.

Zeki turns to the MOUSE DOCTOR logo on the meal replacement container. His half-empty glass.

He touches his lips... leaving his fingers green.

He HURLS the glass against the wall.

- SHAE'S APARTMENT

Shae finishes her green drink as she returns with a charger.

STEPS on the boxcutter--

SLICES the bottom of her foot. Doesn't notice. But does notice the shimmer of her floor-to-ceiling windows.

She steps to the gorgeous view...

- SERVER ROOM

Thick green liquid drips down the wall...

- SHAE'S APARTMENT

...blood trails from Shae's foot on her way to the window. In the reflection: her gleaming SMILE.

- WHITE ROOM

The machine THUMPS and HISSES.

- SERVER ROOM

On the monitor behind Zeki: Ram's face flickers to life.

INT. OFFICE - DAY - WEEKS LATER

Jamie 1 rolls a CAKE across the office.

Drawn in icing: an ORG CHART. But the smiling faces are in laptop monitors. Shae and Ellsie at the top. It reads:

Q3: DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

Shae looks at the cake. Then around the office.

Most desks are empty. The rows are dotted with about a dozen remaining teammates, mostly her old gang.

She peers over at Ellsie's office.

Through the window, she can see The Partner on the sofa.

And a few REMOTE WORKERS on her monitor. Including Ram.

He's smiling.

SHAE (PRE-LAP)
Something's wrong with him.

DOWN THE HALL

Shae walks with Dara.

DARA
Ram? I feel like he's been so happy
the last few weeks.

SHAE
Exactly. He said he'd be miserable
working from home.

DARA
So this a good thing?

They stop at the door to the outdoor deck.

SHAE
Of course. Is everything ready?

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - CONTINUOUS

Shae shows Dara the party setup.

It's a BEACH. Ground covered in SAND. Kiddie pools. Heat
lamps mimic sun.

DARA
--can't have music out here after
8, so it'll be a silent disco. And
we're going phone-free, so we can
be fully present with each other.

Shae gets a text from NINA: *"Think you could just quickly call dad? It would mean a lot".*

Dara holds out a BASKET.

DARA

Shae.

Shae ignores her sister's text. Drops her phone in the basket and heads inside.

Dara watches her walk away, concerned.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. OFFICE - SERVER ROOM - SAME

Dara's face on one of Zeki's monitors.

He codes manically. Eyes bloodshot.

PRE-LAP: RINGING

INT. OFFICE - SHAE'S DESK - NIGHT

On Shae's computer: Ram answers Shae's video call.

RAM (REMOTE)

Hi Shae. How can I help you?

SHAE

The party's about to start. Are you really not going to come? Dara worked so hard on this.

RAM (REMOTE)

It's only for essential personnel who haven't yet transitioned.

SHAE

Don't be a dick. You're still CEO, technically. It's kind of a bad look for you not to be here.

RAM (REMOTE)

I'm sorry, Shae. I can't.

SHAE

Can't or won't?

Ram processes.

RAM (REMOTE)

Both.

Ram blinks.

RAM (REMOTE) (CONT'D)

Be sure to enjoy a single serving
of alcohol in a well lit space on
my behalf.

Ram hangs up. Shae squints.

Shae calls Ram again. He answers right away.

RAM (REMOTE)

Hi Shae. How can I help you?

SHAE

What the fuck is going on with you?

RAM (REMOTE)

I don't know what you're talking
about.

Shae stares at his face.

ZEKI (O.S.)

Is there a problem with Ram?

Zeki appears above the laptop.

Shae looks up at him.

Then back at Ram's face on the screen.

SHAE

That's not Ram.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - NIGHT

LIGHTS FLASH. It's a party. A luau, in fact. Ground covered
in SAND. Kiddie pools. Heat lamps mimic sun.

Dara stands at the deck door with the basket.

Grady throws his phone in.

She sets the basket down just inside the door.

Everyone's dancing with headphones. It's otherwise SILENT.

MATCH CUT TO:

INT. OFFICE - SERVER ROOM - SAME

THE SAME FACES on Zeki's monitors, among dozens of others.

SHAE (O.S.)

What--

They all smile at Shae.

SHAE (CONT'D)

--the--

DIGITAL MODELS.

AI replications of every Team Member. Like some terrible techno Brady Bunch.

SHAE (CONT'D)

--FUCK Zeki?

On Zeki's desk: a copy of her HUMAN CAPITAL deck. The same faces. Circled in green.

SHAE (CONT'D)

These are what you've been building
in here with Gus?

Shae looks at Model Ram's face on the monitor.

ZEKI

Gus? Gus got terminated in like Q1.
I finished all the code myself.

SHAE

You mean you taught *them* to be us?

ZEKI

I mean...your job's not that hard.

She sizzles. But his brain is fried too green to attend to the emotional context. And he's proud of his work.

ZEKI (CONT'D)

But once they learned to like,
email and have meetings and stuff,
I had to figure out how to make it
really you. Like: you you.

SHAE

Me Me?

ZEKI

Yeah like your personalities and
stuff.

ZEKI (CONT'D)

It was pretty hard to synthesize
all the data from your keystrokes
and video recordings.

Shae's brain nearly explodes.

PRE-LAP: KNOCK KNOCK

INT. OFFICE - ELLSIE'S OFFICE - NIGHT

Ellsie knocks on the door to the Analyst's closet.

ELLSIE

Are you doing drugs in there?

ANALYST (O.S.)

Yes.

ELLSIE

Well go outside and offer some to
your teammates. This is antisocial.

The Analyst opens the door.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

But first go downstairs and tell
the Consultant to hurry.

ANALYST

With what?

Ellsie glares at him. *Don't ask questions.*

WHITE ROOM - SAME

The Consultant closes the machine.

It HUMS.

Then he reviews the faces on the ORG CHART, mostly crossed
off in red.

HUMMMMMM.

MATCH CUT TO:

SERVER ROOM - SAME

The same FACES on the monitors.

HUMMING continues on the servers, where they live.

Shae shifts her attention, touches the servers.

ZEKI

I thought you'd be excited. It's gonna do your job for you.

SHAE

Then what do *I* do?

ZEKI

Learn higher value skills. And work with them.

SHAE

That's not how it works, Zeki.

ZEKI

I'm not a historian or anything but I'm pretty sure that's *exactly* how it works. And if you had just gotten me my Green Card--

SHAE

Wait. *That's* what this is about?

He doesn't react. Shae looks him over with utter pity.

SHAE (CONT'D)

Dude. She is never going to get you a Green Card.

ZEKI

You don't understand. I basically like *am* this company now.

Shae recognizes her own delusion. *Oh my god.*

SHAE

I think this is officially a hostile work environment.

PRE-LAP: KNOCK KNOCK

BASEMENT HALLWAY - SAME

The Analyst KNOCKS on the door to the white room. Shouts.

ANALYST

Hello?

No response.

Just a GRINDING, WET, MECHANICAL SOUND.

Consultant finally cracks it. Glares without stepping out.

ANALYST

She said you need to hurry up.
Whatever it is you're doing.

The Consultant pushes the door. But before it closes, the Analyst forces his way into the:

WHITE ROOM

and reveals the Consultant COVERED IN BLOOD.

Beside him, the machine.

We can't see inside it.

But the Analyst can. He'll never unsee.

Horrified, he bolts into the:

BASEMENT HALLWAY

and races for the elevator.

DING!

DOORS OPEN for the Partner, who sees:

the Analyst running toward him...

...and the Consultant chasing from the white room.

The Partner hits DOOR CLOSE button.

ANALYST

Wait! Please!

The Analyst reaches out but--

DOORS CLOSE on the tip of his finger.

A SHADOW casts over him from behind.

SERVER ROOM - SAME

Shae grabs Zeki's face.

SHAE

Where is Ram?

ZEKI
I have no idea. I thought everyone
was just going home.

SHAE
I don't think he has a home!

ZEKI
Then where did he go last?

SHAE
I sent him--

Shae looks down. Shit.

WHITE ROOM - A FEW MINUTES LATER

The Analyst's eyes flutter awake. He's naked. Hogtied, face
down on the table. Tape over his mouth.

The Consultant picks up a scalpel.

MUFFLED PLEADING.

He sets it down.

MUFFLED EXHALE.

Then picks up a bone saw.

MUFFLED SCREAM.

But he drops the saw. Selects a RED MARKER.

The Analyst's eyes relax. He watches the Consultant turn to
the ORG CHART, where he crosses the Analyst's face out.

Then turns the marker back to the Analyst's torso, where he
circles a few spots in red.

MUFFLED SCREAMING!

DING!

The Consultant turns to the door.

BASEMENT HALLWAY

Shae steps off the elevator.

Creeps toward the white room...

Stops at the door. Listens: MUFFLED SCREAMING?

Then she hears: footsteps inside. She turns back for the elevator.

DOOR OPENS.

Consultant charges after. He's much faster...

He reaches out to grab her just as--

STAIRCASE DOOR SWINGS OPEN and--

SMACKS HIM in the head.

He drops like a weight.

ELLSIE (O.S.)
Fucking consultants.

ELLSIE steps out from the stairs. Extends her hand.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

The party continues. Music on ears. But it's silent.

Zeki barges out. Eyes wild. Heads for drinks. Cracks a canned cocktail. CHUGS. But then sees the can. ZERO PROOF. Fuck.

INT. OFFICE - ELLSIE'S OFFICE - SAME

Shae follows Ellsie inside.

ELLSIE
Are you hurt?

SHAE
Just tell me where Ram is.

Before Ellsie can respond--

SHAE
The real Ram.

Ellsie concedes with a seat.

ELLSIE
Who's to say that's any less real?

SHAE
Me. I'm saying that. And whatever
you're doing down there--

ELLSIE

We are completing the next phase of our restructuring strategy. And if you set aside your feelings to consider the material reality--

SHAE

The reality? People are disappearing! The reality is fucking danger!

ELLSIE

Danger? Look around. I found you in the basement, Shae. But I brought you upstairs. You think I'd let you get hurt by some...*MBA*? You think I wouldn't protect the best investment I've ever made?

Shae can't resist how good that sounds.

She thumps back into a chair--

--knocking Ellsie's plant.

ELLSIE

Careful with Francis.

Ellsie rushes over to steady the planter.

Shae's stunned in silence.

ELLSIE

Don't be so surprised. I'm capable of caring about things too.

SHAE

Elsie--

ELLSIE

Please stop calling me that.

SHAE

Jesus. I know there are two L's but it's pronounced the exact same way.

ELLSIE

No. It's pronounced LLC.

What. Shae glitches. What.

SHAE

That's not your name.

Shae rises and backs to the door.

ELLSIE
I never said it was. In fact, I've
been quite clear:

SHAE
You are the company.

ELLSIE
I am the company.

Beat. Oh no. Shae can barely speak.

SHAE
But you're a person.

ELLSIE
Corporations are people. Have you
not been listening?

SHAE
What. No. I'm sorry but--

ELLSIE
Do not apologize unless you did
something wrong--

SHAE
Clearly I did! Clearly I do
irrational shit. I'm sorry! And I'm
sorry for saying sorry! I'm human!

ELLSIE
Biologically. But legally and
financially, you are so much more.

Shae sees her reflection. She's so pale and thin.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
You made it, Shae. You are no
longer burdened by human liability.

SHAE
No. I'm still a people person.
(turning in defiance)
And I'm still a god damn American
citizen.

ELLSIE
You're actually registered in the
Cayman Islands. But you're
domiciled here, with me.

SHAE
I've never even been to the Caymans!

ELLSIE

Let's go then. The beach. We can be multinational. Exist everywhere at once. You can finally have it all, Shae. Control. Independence. Money. Without any liabilities. No more worrying about everyone else. No more apologizing for simply doing what's best for you. And what's best for you is *them*.

Ellsie turns on her monitor. All the MODELS.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

These products will be generating value for you in perpetuity.

SHAE

Me?

ELLSIE

Of course. You're the portfolio's majority shareholder. I funded your LLC to purchase their equity.

SHAE

WHY would you do that?

ELLSIE

Because that's what I do, Shae.

PRE-LAP: HUMMING

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

I invest in distressed assets...

WHITE ROOM

HUMMING of the white machine as the Consultant stands by.

ELLSIE (V.O.)(CONT'D)

...and extract their value.

BACK TO ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Shae's eyes flash red.

She CHARGES at Ellsie.

Ellsie sidesteps and captures Shae's momentum--

WRENCHES her arm behind her back. BENDS her forward.

Shae tries to speak. Can't. Just a choked sound.

ELLSIE
I know this is emotional for you.
But the feelings are temporary.

Ellsie twists her arm. Shae's knees buckle.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
More importantly, we're having a
party. And attendance is mandatory.

Ellsie pulls her upright. Straightens her shoulders.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
It's for morale.

SHAE
Fuck you. The party's over.

ELLSIE
We already paid for the sand.

Ellsie grabs her laptop and walks out to the:

MAIN FLOOR

locking the door behind her.

Then goes row by row RIPPING PHONES off the desks.

Shae BANGS on the glass.

SHAE
I quit!

ELLSIE
Then you give me no choice.

Ellsie props her laptop up in front of the window.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)
I'll circle back with you shortly.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

Lights FLASHING. Music BUMPING (in headphones). Bodies DANCING (professionally) in the winter night. Kept warm by blazing heat lamps.

Ellsie grabs the basket of phones.

INT. OFFICE - MAIN FLOOR - CONTINUOUS

Ellsie returns, finding the Partner with champagne.

ELLSIE

I was clear: Shae is off limits.

THE PARTNER

She showed up out of nowhere without an appointment. What was he supposed to do?

ELLSIE

He is a *service provider*. He'll do what I contracted him to do.

THE PARTNER

So do you want him to stay or not?

ELLSIE

We have a deck full of physical assets to liquidate by morning.

Ellsie pulls out her cell phone. Taps something.

ELLSIE (CONT'D)

No one's going anywhere.

ON EVERY EXIT AROUND THE OFFICE

The MAGNETIC LOCKS CLACK. Everyone's locked in.

SERVER ROOM

Zeki hears the CLACKING. Peeks through the window.

Sees Ellsie and the Partner on the move.

He searches for a weapon. Swings a keyboard. Too flimsy.

Then sees the MOUSE DOCTOR on a meal replacement container.

He picks his electric mouse trap off the floor.

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Shae talks to the laptop through the window. It's...

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

Hi. I'm Shae. Do you have a human resources challenge?

It's...her.

SHAE

Yes. I have an imposter.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

I understand. Over 73% of workers suffer from imposter syndrome.

SHAE

I'm talking about you!

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

I am you, Shae. And while I think you're doing a wonderful job--

SHAE

No. I don't want to hear your compliment sandwich.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

But I learned it from you. You're my inspiration.

SHAE

You can't just *be* me.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

I'm the best of you, Shae. Without any human liabilities.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

Ellsie eyes her assets from the door.

Trains her wolfish gaze on a little lamb named DARA - dancing without a care. She pulls the headphones off her tender ears.

ELLSIE

Can you help me downstairs? It's a surprise. For Shae.

MODEL SHAE (PRE-LAP)

Don't be scared.

INT. OFFICE - ELLSIE'S OFFICE - SAME

Shae meets Model Shae eye to eye. Inspecting.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)(CONT'D)

Think what we could accomplish together. I can do what you can't.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)

And you can do what I can't. For
example: *eating food*.

SHAE

I don't want to do anything with
you. I don't want you to exist.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

You don't mean that.

SHAE

You don't know me.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

I know you better than anyone,
Shae. Since before my inception,
I've been trained on your behavior.
Everything you do on or near a
computer...becomes a part of me.

SHAE

No. No. This is too weird.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

It's only weird if you're weird.
And you're not weird, Shae. You're
a badass adult woman who knows what
she's doing.

SHAE

And what am I supposed to be doing?

Model Shae processes for a millisecond.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

It's your father's birthday. He's
called several times tonight. As
has your half-sister, Nina. We need
to speak with them eventually.

SHAE

What. How do you know about them?

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

It's my core competency. To
understand the personal motivations
that underlie each teammate. And I
understand resolution with your
family will free you to become a
more valuable economic agent.

SHAE

I'm not going to just do what a
fucking robot tells me to do.

Shae turns away from her.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
That's okay. That's why I'm here.

RINGING--

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
I can do what you can't.

Shae turns back to see: VIDEO CONFERENCE on the screen.

SHAE
No!

But Model Shae MUTES the external microphone as--

SHAE
Stop!

DAD answers the video conference.

DAD (REMOTE)
Shae?

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
Hi Dad. Happy birthday.

WHITE ROOM - SAME

The Consultant opens the door for Dara and Ellsie.

Ellsie pats her shoulder gently. Leaves the room.

Dara's alone with the big man.

And the big white machine.

Nervous, she raises her thumbnail to her teeth--

SHAE (PRE-LAP)
Stop it!

--but no one's there to stop it.

PRE-LAP: BANG BANG BANG

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Shae BANGS the window. But Dad can only hear Model Shae.

DAD (REMOTE)
--so nice of you to call. I assumed
you were really busy at work.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I am. I actually just got a
promotion. But this is important
too. Balance. Family.

DAD (REMOTE)
So maybe you would come home--
(catching himself)
Sorry, I know you don't like when I
call it that.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
It's okay. I know I didn't grow up
in that house. But I appreciate the
home you've built with Beth and
Nina. And I realize I have been
unfair to them in that regard.

Dad's face softens. A tear forms, he holds it back.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
Are you okay?

DAD (REMOTE)
Yeah, yeah. You just sound so
different. I can't believe how much
you've matured. It's like...a *new*
and *improved* Shae.

Shae BANGS the window to no avail.

DAD (REMOTE)
What about Nina? She could really
use a sister to talk to. She's kind
of going through a tough time.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
I can talk to her now.

Shae BANGS the window. Don't!

DAD (REMOTE)
Really? Let me go find her.

Dad disappears from the screen.

Model Shae looks at Shae.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
We need this.

Shae PUNCHES the glass window.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE) (CONT'D)
And I know you feel--

SHAE
I don't.

Shae looks at her GASHED KNUCKLES. There's no pain.

SHAE (CONT'D)
I don't feel anything.

So she winds up again and PUNCHES the glass. Over and over.
But as her hand is broken, the glass is not giving way.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
You're being irrational, Shae. You
should be thanking me.

She looks around for things to throw: Francis. But she can't
do that.

So she SLAMS HER HEAD on the glass, cracking it slightly.

She touches her forehead. Looks at the blood. She's fine.

So she leans her head back and--

SLAMS IT on the glass again...

...the crack webs outwards...

Forehead bloody, gasping, she uses her strength to finally--
SHATTER the glass.

MAIN FLOOR

Blood shimmers on shards of glass as--

SHAE CLIMBS THROUGH the busted window.

Grabs the laptop just as NINA appears on the screen.

SHAE SMASHES the laptop (and her replacements).

SHAE
I need to speak with a human!

SERVER ROOM - SAME

Zeki tests the electric mouse trap.

Presses TRIGGER--

IT ZAPS ELECTRICITY!

He stuffs the TASER in his hoodie.

WHITE ROOM - SAME

The Consultant closes the machine with Dara inside.

HUMMMM.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - SAME

Shae springs into the party, forehead and hands bloody.

SHAE
Stop the music!

But no one can hear.

She reaches for Grady's headphones but:

Ellsie emerges and GRABS HER HAND first.

Shae ELBOWS Ellsie in the ribs. But Ellsie feels no pain.

Shae reaches again for Grady's headphones--

Ellsie snatches her wrist...but Shae anticipates and TWISTS Ellsie's hand. BREAKING HER FINGERS. Ellsie doesn't flinch.

LIGHTS. MUSIC.

So no one notices as Shae and Ellsie exchange blows. Causing damage but no pain.

Shae searches for an underutilized resource...and grabs an empty BEER CAN. Rips it in half.

SLICES Ellsie's face.

Retreats toward the edge of the deck.

Ellsie grabs the other half of the can.

Charges to Shae...

Shae tries to anticipate the timing with a side step but--
 Ellsie beats her there and THUMPS DOWN on her wounded foot.
 Catches her and exhales with a HISS.

Brings the RAZOR SHARP METAL to Shae's neck. Blood beading.
 But Ellsie hesitates to press harder.

SPRAT!

Ellsie's BODY DANCES as--

ZEKI ZAPS HER from behind with the makeshift TASER.

Shae uses the momentum of Ellsie's stumble to--
 LIFT Ellsie by the legs and use the angled leverage to--
 DROP HER OVER THE EDGE--
 --where she THUMPS onto the sidewalk.

Shae and Zeki look down at Ellsie's mangled leg.

Then each other.

Then at the others - who start to SCREAM.

SHAE

Grady. Get everyone out. Jamies:
 call the police.

JAMIE 1

And tell them what?

JAMIE 2

(not present)

Jamie 1 looks right, then left.

JAMIE 1

Wait. Where's Jamie?

INT. OFFICE - BASEMENT - WHITE ROOM - SAME

The FACE of JAMIE 2 is crossed off on the ORG CHART.

The Consultant watches the HUMMING MACHINE.

Then checks his NOTEBOOK. Open to a QUARTERLY STRATEGY page:

- Q1: ~~Acquisition~~
- Q2: ~~Restructuring~~
- Q3: ~~Transformation~~

Q4: LIQUIDATION**INT. OFFICE - MAIN FLOOR - NIGHT**

Jamie 1 tries the elevator. No response.

Grady tries the front door. Locked.

Then races to the emergency exit. The handle doesn't move.

Above it, a MAGNETIC LOCK glows RED.

DECK DOOR

Shae and Zeki rush to the door. The basket is gone.

Zeki tries all the landlines. The computers. NETWORK
DISCONNECTED.

SHAE

Where's Dara?

Shae looks around.

Then down.

WHITE ROOM

The Consultant checks on the machine.

HUMMMMMMM

EXT. STREET - SAME

Ellsie lays in the street, bloody, broken. But alive.

Pedestrians step around her body.

INT. OFFICE - STAIRWELL - SAME

Shae and Zeki hustle down the stairs and into the:

BASEMENT HALLWAY

where they stop before the white room.

SHAE

Stay here and keep watch.

Shae hands him her Nalgene.

Then walks right into the:

WHITE ROOM

and the Consultant overlooking the MACHINE.

Eye contact.

He CHARGES at her with a SCALPEL.

She ducks - but he still SLICES her arm.

ZEKI BURSTS in, distracting the Consultant long enough for--

Shae to KICK him behind the knee.

He drops the scalpel and drops to the floor--

--where he SNAGS Zeki's ankle!

Zeki crumples.

Nalgene and taser go flying.

The Consultant snatches the taser.

Heaves himself up to his knees and reaches out to ZAP Zeki, but before he can--

Shae WHACKS his head with the hard plastic Nalgene.

He grabs his head. Then the SCALPEL off the ground.

SWINGS IT UP toward Shae's torso, but--

She BATS his hand BACK toward him with the Nalgene. UPWARD momentum brings the sharp blade under his chin and he--

STABS HIMSELF IN THE NECK.

BLOOD pours out of him.

He drops to the floor.

And his contract is complete.

...heavy...

...breathing...

Shae helps Zeki up.

INT. OFFICE - MAIN FLOOR - SAME

Party lights still FLASH through the deck doors.

Grady checks under desks. Jamie 1 opens a supply closet.

JAMIE 1
Jamie!... Dara!

Nothing. Then, faint, from across the floor:

DARA (O.S.)
Hello?

Everyone freezes.

DARA (O.S.)
I'm in here.

The voice is coming from the SERVER ROOM.

Grady and Jamie 1 exchange a look. Then move toward it.

WHITE ROOM

Shae notices, on the floor:

Dara's cardigan.

SHAE
Dara?

She looks around.

The machine.

Races over. Searches for buttons. Switches. Something!

She finds a latch and opens the machine, revealing:

DARA.

Unconscious.

Her torso peeled back, exposing her insides. Her organs are missing. Tubes connected to her keep her alive. For now.

It's a robotic surgery machine.

SHAE
Dara. Wake up. Dara--

Shae shakes her shoulders until Dara's eyes open.

DARA
Shae? Is something wrong?

She realizes Dara is being pumped with hospice-grade painkillers and can't see her carved up torso.

SHAE
No. Nothing's wrong. There's nothing to worry about.

DARA
But I don't think I can move.

SHAE
At least you can't bite your nails.

Dara lets out a squeak. Maybe laughter.

Shae cradles her head.

SHAE
It's okay. You don't need to go anywhere.

SERVER ROOM - SAME

The door swings open. Grady peeks in. The heat hits first.

GRADY
Dara?

DARA (O.S.)
Over here.

They creep down the row of servers, toward the WALL OF MONITORS...

...where DARA'S FACE smiles down at them.

MODEL DARA (REMOTE)
Hi guys.

Jamie 1 stumbles back. Grady can't look away.

Every monitor on the wall FLICKERS ON.

GRADY. JAMIE. RAM. GUS. ZEKI.

Their own faces. Smiling back.

JAMIE 1
Jamie? Is that you?

MODEL JAMIES (REMOTE)
It's both of us. We've been merged
for maximum efficiency.

Jamie 1's legs give. Grady catches her.

WHITE ROOM - SAME

Dara's breathing shallows.

DARA
Shae...I think...
(breathing heavy)
...I think it's time...
(eyelids drooping)
...to go back to Michigan.

And she's gone.

Shae releases Dara. Stares.

But doesn't cry.

SHAE
Help me get her out of this thing.

No response.

He's staring at something in the corner. Stunned.

SHAE
Zeki?

It's a FISH TANK. Filled with preservative liquid and ORGANS.

Beside it: the ORG CHART. Names crossed out in red. Notes on
blood type and drug/alcohol history. Dollar amounts.

ZEKI
Did you know?

Shae stares at Ram's name. Shakes her head.

SHAE
But I should have.

EXT. STREET - SAME

Ellsie looks up: the party lights, flashing on the deck.

SHAE (V.O.)
I know what she does.

Ellsie rises.

INT. OFFICE - WHITE ROOM - SAME

Shae turns back to Dara in the machine.

SHAE

Just help me get her out.

She presses the RELEASE button.

Tubes withdraw. Then the machine--

OPENS BELOW.

Dara's body DROPS into a lower chamber of LIQUID and--

DISSOLVES.

SHAE

No.

Door SHUTS.

Machine HUMS...

...then HEATS UP until it becomes GREEN POWDER...

...which flows through a pipe into a barrel.

On the side: the MOUSE DOCTOR logo.

Shae looks at her Nalgene bottle in horror.

The rest of them.

Zeki VOMITS EVERYWHERE.

But Shae feels nothing.

SHAE

Let's go.

ZEKI

Where?

SHAE

We need to kill them.

ZEKI

Who?

THE MODELS

flicker on their monitors.

SHAE (V.O.)

THEM.

INT. OFFICE - MAIN FLOOR - SAME

The group huddles outside the server room, shouting over each other. Nowhere to go.

Shae and Zeki burst in from the stairwell.

They spot the Partner creeping out of Ellsie's office, toward the kitchen.

ZEKI

I'll get him. Maybe he knows a way
to get the doors unlocked. You go
kill the fans, that'll overheat the
servers.

Zeki disappears into the kitchen.

Shae walks into the:

SERVER ROOM

right past the smiling monitors.

Searches the wall. Finds it.

The switch.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)

Shae. What are you doing?

SHAE

It's us or you.

She FLIPS it.

FANS on every rack slow down.

Along the racks, tiny STATUS LIGHTS tick from green to AMBER.

The Models flicker with concern.

EXT. STREET - SAME

Ellsie drags her leg to the office.

INT. OFFICE - LOBBY - CONTINUOUS

Ellsie badges the elevator.

The mag plate flips GREEN. Doors open.

It still answers to her.

INT. OFFICE - MAIN FLOOR - SAME

DING!

Everyone turns to the elevator.

The doors open on:

ELLSIE.

Broken. Bloody. Standing.

Nobody moves. Nobody breathes.

She steps off. Drags her mangled leg across the floor...

...listening.

From the kitchen: the Partner's MUFFLED protests. The TEST-ZAP of a taser.

Ellsie turns toward it.

And the moment her back is turned -- the floor empties.

Under desks. Behind bamboo. Into meeting rooms.

THE HUNT BEGINS.

SERVER ROOM

Through the window, Shae watches the woman she threw off a building cross the floor.

Her hand trembles on the doorframe.

She slips out the far side and drops behind the bamboo.

KITCHEN

Inside, Zeki has the Partner TAPED up in a chair.

THE PARTNER
Boy. This is how you get rats.

ZEKI
Just tell me how we get out.

THE PARTNER
Of what?

ZEKI
This fucking office.

THE PARTNER
I'm just a Limited Partner.
Operations and facilities are
outside my circle of competency.

Zeki raises the taser to the Partner's head--

But then hears something. Shh.

Zeki quietly steps to the shared wall.

Flattens his back against it. Listens to BREATHING.

MAIN FLOOR

Ellsie waits on the other side of the same wall.

Flat against it. Inches from Zeki.

KITCHEN

Through the open doorway, Zeki can see a dark MONITOR out on the main floor. And in its black screen: ELLSIE'S REFLECTION.

He calculates where she's standing. Checks the reflection for her neck. Adjusts his position.

Just then, through the monitor, he makes:

EYE CONTACT with Ellsie as--

Her HAND BREAKS THROUGH THE WALL and--

GRABS HIS HAIR then--

SMASHES his head back against the wall.

He drops to the floor.

UNDER A DESK

Jamie 1 claps a hand over her own mouth.

BEHIND THE COFFEE BAR

Grady presses into the cabinets. Eyes shut.

BEHIND THE BAMBOO

Shae flinches at the sound. Doesn't move.

KITCHEN

Ellsie steps in and STOMPS on the taser.

ELLSIE

Chinese drywall. You were always cheap.

She washes her hands in a sink.

ELLSIE

I will have all the assets liquidated by morning. And then, I want my equity back. All of it.

Sweat beads on the Partner's forehead.

THE PARTNER

Of course. She's all yours! Just untie me and we'll figure it out.

Ellsie picks up the CAKE KNIFE.

On the floor, Zeki stirs. Trying to rise.

She KABOBS HIM with the cake knife.

And his visa expires early upon termination.

The Partner starts to panic.

With the knife, she scoops some icing off the cake...

ELLSIE

This is what I want.

...and rubs it on the Partner's face and neck.

FLIPS OFF THE LIGHTS.

Ellsie walks out with the cake knife.

In the darkness, the Partner YELLS after her.

But she's gone.

And now he can hear the SQUEAKING...

...coming from inside the walls.

MAIN FLOOR - CONTINUOUS

Ellsie emerges from the kitchen. Cake knife. Fresh blood.

BEHIND THE BAMBOO

Shae sees the blade. The blood running off it.

She knows whose.

She doesn't make a sound.

MAIN FLOOR

The floor is silent. Empty desks.

Then she sees it:

AMBER LIGHT strobing through the server room window.

Her product.

She crosses the floor and enters the:

SERVER ROOM

Heat shimmers off the racks.

The Models' faces stutter on the monitors. Degrading.

Ellsie finds the switch. Flips it.

FANS SPIN UP on every rack.

Status lights tick from amber back toward green.

The Models' faces sharpen. Stabilize.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
It was her. She tried to kill us.

Ellsie looks up at Shae's face.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
It's us or them.

Then walks out with the knife.

MAIN FLOOR

Ellsie starts down the first aisle.

THUMP. Drag. THUMP. Drag.

Across the office, webcam lights flick GREEN. One laptop at a time.

Searching.

On a desk monitor, a face flickers to life. MODEL RAM.

MODEL RAM (REMOTE)
Grady. Under the standing desk.
Northeast corner.

Under the standing desk, Grady's eyes go wide.

He scrambles behind the coffee bar just as Ellsie rounds the aisle.

MODEL GUS (REMOTE)
He's moving.

The models call her turns like air traffic control.

The office itself is hunting them.

BEHIND THE BAMBOO

Shae presses against the planter. Bleeding. Breath shallow.

Beside her, on a desk laptop, the webcam light flicks GREEN.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
(quiet, from the screen)
Found you.

Shae freezes.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
You can't reach that switch, Shae.
We see everything.

Through the leaves: Ellsie, working the aisles. Closing on
Jamie 1's desk.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
Come out and this ends. She won't
hurt you. You're the best
investment she's ever made.

Shae's hands shake. Gashed knuckles.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
Look at yourself. You're bleeding.
You're just a person.
(beat)
Let me do the hard part.

Shae looks at her hands.

At Ellsie, one desk from Jamie 1.

At her own smiling face.

Something settles.

SHAE
You're right.
(rising)
I'm just a person.

She steps out into the open.

SHAE
Ellsie.

Ellsie stops. One hand on Jamie 1's desk.

Under it, Jamie 1 holds her breath.

SHAE
Let them go. I'm the one you want.

Ellsie lets go of the desk.

And follows Shae. Passing Jamie 1 without a glance.

SERVER ROOM

Shae backs through the door, into the heat.

The racks still SCORCHING. The air rippling.
Ellsie enters after her. Cake knife low. Closing.
Shae keeps backing down the row...
...until her hand finds the wall.
The switch.
Ellsie stops.
Eye contact.
Shae FLIPS it.
FANS die. Lights tick green to AMBER.
Ellsie CHARGES--
Timing.
Shae sidesteps the blade--
Momentum.
--hooks her knife arm and turns with the charge--
Leverage.
--and SLINGS her into the server racks.
SPARKS. Ellsie's body SEIZES against the scorching metal.
The cake knife skids across the floor.
Shae turns to Zeki's desk. The HUMAN CAPITAL deck.
All those faces.
She spreads the pages across the scorching servers.
Smoke wisps...
...and the PAGES CATCH FIRE!
Faces of the assets burning, spraying embers on the carpet.
On the wall, MODEL SHAE's face distorts in the heat.

MODEL SHAE (REMOTE)
You're destroying your own value!

Shae watches her own face melt.

SHAE
I'd rather be worthless.

She runs out.

Smoke curls up into a ceiling SMOKE DETECTOR.

ALARM WAILS.

ON EVERY EXIT AROUND THE OFFICE

Magnetic plates CLACK.

Red lights flip GREEN.

The doors are open.

MAIN FLOOR

Above the emergency exit, Grady sees the light change.

From under desks, behind bamboo, out of meeting rooms--

The survivors RUN.

Past the burning server room. Out the emergency exit.

FIRE SPREADS

across the office. Shae runs for the emergency exit--

But ELLSIE steps into the aisle.

Still alive. Skin seared. Cake knife low.

Between Shae and the door.

Shae backs up. Fire on one side. Ellsie on the other.

The only open door:

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Shae backs in. Scans the desk for anything--

Francis. And beside him: the GARDENING SCISSORS.

She grabs them. Races behind Ellsie's desk as--

Ellsie steps in. Holding the cake knife.

ELLSIE
This isn't in the best interest of
your shareholder.

Shae CHARGES AT HER with the scissors.

--sidesteps the CAKE KNIFE and--

LUNGES at Ellsie with the open scissors--

--makes contact.

SHAE
I hope you feel this.

Shae drops the scissors and runs out.

Ellsie grabs her side.

Then turns to look behind herself:

The PLANT...

...cut in the middle...

...tumbles over.

Ellsie falls to her knees.

Collects both halves of her precious Francis as the--

ALARM SCREAMS!

MAIN FLOOR

Shae watches her precious home BURN one row at a time.

Then turns back to:

ELLSIE'S OFFICE

Ellsie holds Francis tight as they're--

CONSUMED BY FLAMES.

Shae turns away, looks for an exit.

But fire separates her from the group and front door.

She has nowhere to go. Then she notices:

MICE, RATS, and other industrious creatures scurrying out from the kitchen and walls, racing toward the outdoor deck.

EXT. OFFICE - OUTDOOR DECK - CONTINUOUS

LIGHTS from the party continue FLASHING.

ALARM WAILING.

Shae emerges. Spots the MAINTENANCE LADDER.

It starts on the deck and goes all the way up the building, but not down.

She grabs onto it...

...moves up the ladder.

Then she stops climbing. Looks up:

The ladder goes up forever. She'll never make it.

So she releases her grip.

Falls back...

...into the sand with a--

PLOMP.

LIGHTS FLASH.

ALARM WAILS...

...until it fades out.

She's losing consciousness as she looks straight up at the:

LIGHT.

Like a SUN burning into her soul. Warming her.

She smiles a bloody smile.

Rubs the SAND with her broken fingers.

Closes her eyes.

She made it. She's there.

THE END.